# 'Round the Mountainside

Quarterly newsletter for Coolfont Mountainside Association

Winter 2020

## Giving Back

**by Jason Géno, CMA President**

When our family purchased our home at Coolfont over 13 years ago, our daughters were ages two and four. We were so amazed at how quickly the community took us in as part of the CMA family. Within the first year, we engaged neighbors and learned how important it was to volunteer in the CMA community. Not only did we see neighbors pulling together to beautify the pool, but we also established friendships by volunteering.

What I've learned by volunteering at CMA is that coming together as a community of volunteers enriches our lives. I also see the positive impact volunteering has had on our daughters – it has helped them learn to develop relationships with others of all ages .

This is my second time on the CMA Board and second time as President. I am excited to be volunteering again as the Board members are all passionate about the community. There is an excitement in the group about doing the best we can to move CMA forward.

Of course, there is always a need for more volunteers at CMA. We welcome people with various skills to help us solve a multitude of issues. We have a number of committees that come together to make our community a better place. So, if you want to further enrich your life and give back to CMA, please consider joining us at a Board meeting or potluck to learn about volunteer opportunities. You never know, you could have a lot of fun while developing long term friendships.

See page 4 for information about some of the volunteer opportunities.

## UPCOMING EVENTS

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Board of Directors Meeting | March 14, 10:00 am | CMA Office |
| Potluck Dinner | March 14, 6:00 pm | TBD - See page 2 |
| Board of Directors Meeting | May 9, 10:00 am | CMA Office |
| Potluck Dinner | May 9, 6:00 pm | TBD - See page 2 |
| Pool Clean Up Day (Tentative) | May 16, 1:00 pm | Community Pool |
| Pool Opens | May 23 | Community Pool |
| Memorial Day Event | May 23 | Details in Spring Newsletter |

# Newcomers & Potlucks

**by Rosemary Bigelow, Welcome Chair**

We had two new families purchase properties in CMA this fall. Larry and Stephanie Barker bought the lot at H-5 and have begun construction on a home. Eric Lienhard and Heidi Splane bought G-5, (formerly owned by Liz Dane and Lesley Frowick). Both have been contacted by the Welcome Committee and we look forward to visiting them to share information about CMA and Berkeley Springs.



**the potluck club**

There were two potluck dinners held this fall. Marian Condon and Larry Levinson hosted the November potluck at their lovely home, Point of View, on Bobcat Drive. The December potluck was hosted by Dennis and Evelyn Brydges at their home, i Ponti Vecchi, on Bobcat Drive where we were treated to beautiful holiday decorations and outstanding eggnog!

CMA is a very congenial and social community. Potlucks are a great way to meet some of your Coolfont neighbors and to see some of the unique homes in our community. Potlucks are typically held on the evening of scheduled Board meetings thus a good way to meet some of your CMA Board members, as well. You will find your neighbors to be a diverse and fascinating group of people.

During the warmer months, community social events center around the pool and barn. Potlucks are scheduled during the cooler spring and fall months in a Coolfont member's home. The 2020 potluck schedule is shaping up already. We welcome residents to volunteer to host a potluck dinner.

Available Potluck Dates:

- March 14, 6pm
- May 9, 6pm
- November 14, 6pm
- December 12, 6pm

For details or to volunteer as host, contact Rosemary Bigelow, 304-258-5352.




# Get On Board!

In December, the Board bid farewell to long-time Board member and community volunteer, Joan Claybrook. (Thanks again, Joan, for all you've done for the community!) Joan's resignation leaves a vacant seat on the Board. Per the CMA bylaws, the Board may appoint someone to serve out the remainder of the term - which is until December 2020.

Board members attend Board meetings (about 8 per year) and the Annual Meeting in September. They help manage the business of the Association by reviewing reports from committees, approving and managing contracts, allocating resources, and providing feedback and guidance to members, when appropriate. Board members may also serve as a liaison to one or more committees.

Board members may volunteer many hours, or only a few - whatever they are comfortable doing. The pay is the same: $0. But the benefits are priceless!

If you would like more information or are interested in serving on the Board, please contact the CMA President, Jason Geno at jeg1568@gmail.com, or CMA Secretary, Tom Holz at tlholz@me.com.

Please don't delay, it's likely that the Board will appoint someone to the vacant seat at the Board Meeting on March 14, 2020.

## 2020 Board Meetings

Meetings are at 10:00 am at the CMA office:

- March 14
- May 9
- June 13
- August 8
- November 14
- December 12

# Cold Run Valley Road – Decoding the Fractions

**by Eric J. Lienhard (G-5)**

As you drive through West Virginia, you may have noticed that some street signs contain a white circle with either a whole number or "fraction" on them. Cold Run Valley Road is one such road, and depending on the direction you come from or map you look at there is either a 9 in the "numerator" or a 38; and 10 in the "denominator" or a 6 respectively. So, what are these numbers and do they have any significance?

These numbers are part of the WV Department of Transportation numbering system for county roads, and have zero significance for addressing or wayfinding. No one describes the Coolfont community as "off of Route 9 over 10." (Yes, that is the prescribed way for saying it!) Although there is little awareness of the system, there is an interesting and unusual history.

In 1917, the State Legislature formed the State Road Commission, with one of its principle responsibilities; create a system of state primary roads connecting all County Seats. These quickly become known as "inter-county" or main roads, while others roads in the State took on the classification of county-district or just district roads. In 1922, the initial system of state numbered routes was published by the Commission, and represents the oldest class of numbered roads in the State. Today, they are better known as State Highways, with odd numbers having a directional significance of east-west, while even numbers, north-south. (opposite from U.S. highways)

On May 16, 1933, the State Legislature passed a law bringing every public road in West Virginia under State Control; and by July of the same year, the Secondary State Highway or County Route System was established. The responsibility of more than 29,000 miles of public roads in West Virginia were placed under the State Road Commission control. The Commission quickly went to work inventorying and mapping these minor roads, more universally known today as "county roads".




Since these minor roads were viewed as "tributaries" of the state highways they branched off from, they were assigned a number in fractional format. The numerator represents the State Road the road branches off of, while the denominator was assigned in order of when the state added the road to their inventory, or at the time the road was commissioned. Originally, the initial assigned collection of fractional county road numbers did work their way numerically, but as areas grew, and new roads were built, they no longer provide this wayfinding benefit. But here's the catch: The denominator "reset" at the county line!

Cold Run Valley Road (9/10) therefore was the tenth spur (from east to west) off of county Route 9. This spur runs from CR 9 to 522. Cold Run Valley Road also shares route designation of 38 over 6, the sixth spur (from north to south) off of former county route 38 (Valley Road, Hancock Road), now US 522 from Hancock, MD to the Virginia state line. Interesting enough, Rock Gap Road (38/6) from US 522 to Cold Run Valley Rd is also county route 38 over 6.

The county route number designations seem to be primarily for the benefit of mapmakers and civil engineers, and are rarely used by locals. After 90 years use, numerous anomalies in the system exist today. The "numerator" designations never change, even if the road they reference is rerouted or abandoned. As populations grow, roads become major connecting thoroughfares such as US 522 and lose their destinations. Names of roads often change, new roads are built, roads get extended, and new connections between roads are made, while others disappear altogether.

So, next time you are traveling in West Virginia, take a look at the road signs and you may be able to decode the hidden meaning behind those fractions!

# Volunteer Opportunities!

## Firewise Committee

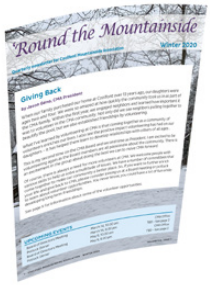
About 17 years ago, Richard Kaufman, serving as CMA Board President, was invited by Rodger Ozburn at the Division of Forestry to attend a meeting at the local fire department. The meeting was about a new program coming to West Virginia offering support and advice to communities adapting to living with wildfires. Richard attended the meeting and realized the Firewise Program would benefit the heavily wooded community. As of December 2014, CMA officially became the first group in West Virginia to join the Firewise program.

Since then, CMA has remained a member in good standing - meeting all the annual requirements. In 2017, the National Fire Protection Association reviewed and updated the Firewise USA program renewal requirements. As of 2018, in addition to the annual $24.14/house fees (usually offset with volunteer hours), CMA is now required to complete an action plan every three years and a risk assessment every five years. Despite these additional requirements, we are optimistic we can remain an active and committed member of Firewise.

To help reach this goal, we welcome any new volunteers that would be interested in joining our current "team of one" to complete risk assessments for each home in the community and formulate an action plan based on the results of the risk assessments. If you are interested in helping with the CMA Firewise program, please contact Cathy Levey at mccm2012@hotmail.com.

## Newsletter Committee

To help keep our members informed, CMA publishes this community newsletter each quarter. Issues are emailed to members at the beginning of February, May, August and November. We are always in need of general interest articles, recipes, local restaurant or entertainment reviews, helpful how-to information and - most of all - photos – of scenery, animals, residents, events, whatever! You can volunteer from the comfort of your own home! We welcome submissions in nearly any format (no stone tablets, please). If you have something to share with your CMA neighbors, email it directly to coolfont.news@gmail.com.


Round the Mountainside

We also need someone to proofread the newsletter before it's sent out to members. This takes about an hour to review text, test hyperlinks, and send edits back – only once per quarter at the end of the preceding month (Jan, Apr, Jul, Oct). If you have an eagle eye – or not – and would like to help, please send an email to coolfont.news@gmail.com.(Bonus: You get an advanced look at the new issue!)

## Neighborhood Watch Committee

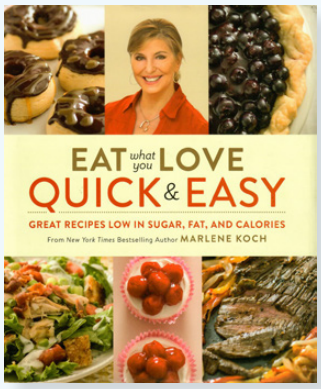
Recently the CMA Board voted to change the name of the Security Committee to the Neighborhood Watch Committee, more realistically reflecting the volunteer nature of our daily patrols. Volunteer patrols began on September 12, 2010 under the direction and expertise of Jason Geno, current CMA Board President. At present, we have five volunteers who make patrols seven days a week. Marsha and Terry Moore, full-timers at CMA, have been covering weekends since 2017. John Fontanes, who owns two cabins here, has covered one day a week since October 4, 2018 and Bob Neuman, another full-timer, has covered one day a week since October 15, 2018. Cathy Levey covers the other weekdays. Daily coverage is assured through close communication among the patrols, covering for each other as needed. Night patrols are done as the need arises, particularly during peak occupancy periods.

We continue to check for any safety concerns and coordinate with the site managers about any concerns that may have occurred between their regular rounds. Additionally, we coordinate with rental agents to ensure safe and pleasant stays for our rental guests and their nearby neighbors.

The Neighborhood Watch Committee can always use more volunteers to help with daily patrols. If you're interested,, please contact Cathy Levey at mccm2012@hotmail.com.

# Eat What You Love

**by Joe Van Meter (K-16)**




This cookbook, by Marlene Koch, is one of a set of three cookbooks for dishes that are low in sugar and fat. Included with each recipe is a list of nutrients, to include fat and glucose count. Each of the three "Eat What You Love" volumes contains over 300 recipes.

This favorite recipe is a quick and easy-to-prepare turkey chili. Why turkey? It's lower in fat than beef. (This dish is particularly suited for now - the dead of winter.)

This is one of my wife, Cindy's, favorites.

## Good & Easy Turkey Chili

**1 teaspoon canola oil**
**1 medium onion, chopped**
**1 medium red or green pepper, chopped**
**1 pound lean ground turkey**
**2 tablespoons chili powder**
**2 teaspoons cumin**
**1 (28-ounce) can crushed tomatoes**
**2 tablespoons barbecue sauce**
**1 (15-ounce) can reduced sodium kidney beans, rinsed and drained**
**Pinch of cayenne pepper**

1. Heat the oil in a large saucepan over medium-high heat. Add the onion and bell pepper and saute for 3 to 4 minutes, or until slightly softened.
2. Add the turkey and cook, turning to break up the meat, until it begins to brown. Add the chili powder and cumin and cook for 1 minute.
3. Add remaining 4 ingredients along with ½ cup of water. Stir well and simmer for 15 minutes.

NUTRITION INFORMATION PER SERVING: (1 cup) Calories 220; Carbohydrate 22g (Sugars 4g); Total Fat 7g (Sat Fat 2g); Protein 18g; Fiber 7g; Cholesterol 60mg; Sodium 340mg

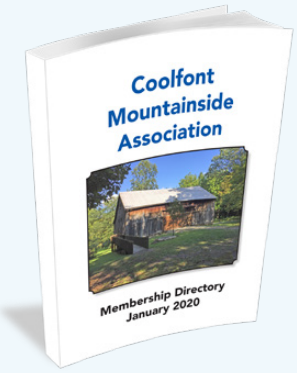
Food Exchanges: 2 Lean Meat, 2 Vegetable, 1 Starch; Carbohydrate Choices: 1½; Weight Watcher Plus Point Comparison: 5

## Did you know...

**Need a ride?** Long time CMA water system contractor, Tom Hall, is an Uber driver in Berkeley Springs. Use the app to schedule a ride.

**Breakfast Anytime!** Charlotte's Cafe is now open for breakfast and lunch. They serve breakfast all day! You'll find great service, pleasant surroundings, and tasty food. Open until 4pm, every day, except closed on Wednesdays. Visit them at 495 S. Washington Street

# Directory Assistance




New membership directories were mailed to all owners at their billing address in early January. If you didn't receive your copy of the directory, please contact Dawne Holz at dawneholz@gmail.com.

## Updates

Please be sure to update your directory with these changes. We will also update the PDF of the directory available on the CMA website (under Owners/Documents).

### Table of Contents:

Update to correct page numbers, as follows:


Membership Roster by Lot Number 13
CMA Community Map 14
Membership Roster by Last Name 7


### Resident updates:

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| H-8 | Elmer Broxson | (202) 333-8872 |
| R-2, R-3 | Richard Kaufman | (301) 605-7102 |

# Water and Sewer Update

**by Cathy Levey, Water & Sewer Chair**

Over the past year, I've had the pleasure of working with the crew of Warm Springs Public Service District (WSPSD). CMA contracted with them in January 2019 to manage our water and sewer systems. Scott Crunkleton is the General Manager, Monty Kerns is the Chief Water Operator, and Andy McKenzie is the new Wastewater Operator (replacing Terry Cross who is retiring). Monty is our primary point of contact on the water system and Josh Hoffman and Jon Mechem are the newest operators in training. They all bring skill and a daily dedication to the management of CMA systems. We've never had to worry – they are always available when needed to maintain the system.

Although available 24/7, WSPSD staff are not on-site around the clock, giving me the opportunity to serve as an additional set of "eyes" on the water system. During nearly daily rounds, I assess the viability of the water system by monitoring the facilities, checking levels in the pump house, reservoirs and chlorine treatment tanks, and monitoring section meters to detect leaks. Through this "team effort" of oversight by WSPSD staff and myself, we gain early detection of any potential issues and a lower risk of emergencies. This allows us to plan for repairs and place more focus on projects that will improve the system.

Recently, Tom Holz, CMA Board Secretary and liaison to Water and Sewer, with help from Joe Van Meter, extended the life of our Sensaphone alarms on the water system. The Sensaphones were transitioned from outdated 3G modems to new 4G modems - also reducing the monthly cost for cellular service. Without this work, our alarm systems would become obsolete! The alarms are a critical warning system in the event of a low water level in the reservoirs and will trigger a phone call to WSPSD in the event of a low level, allowing time to diagnose the problem and accomplish repairs.

We are looking to the future and how we will continue to meet the water and sewer needs of CMA and changes are anticipated. Anyone interested in helping plan and manage these systems is most welcome to be a part of this critical CMA infrastructure. Contact Cathy Levey at mccm2012@hotmail.com.

# Rules & Regulations
## Preservation and Conservation of the Woodland

Owners, their guests and their tenants are asked to give high priority to preservation and enhancement of natural terrain and natural plant growth especially large and well preserved specimens, or exceptionally desirable species...

**Preservation and Use of Common Property:** Lands owned by CMA are held exclusively for the common enjoyment of CMA members. Such common land is maintained in a natural or wilderness state unless improved with recreational facilities, permanent parks, trails, open spaces and other common facilities approved by the Association. No other use is permitted.

**Tree Cutting is Restricted:** Owners may remove, top or trim trees located within 10 feet of their house without approval, however no other trees over six inches in diameter may be cut; topped or trimmed on any lot or on common ground without written CMA approval. Requests ... are reviewed promptly and approved routinely by CMA.

**Brush Fire Prevention:** ... Residents are encouraged to clear leaves and burnable materials including firewood stacks within a distance of 30 feet of their residence as well as remove flammable materials stored under decks.

**Exterior Fires:** Open fires in or on the ground are not permitted. Stand-alone exterior gas, wood and charcoal grills and fire receptacles are permitted if factory manufactured and maintained in good condition. Receptacles in disrepair must be replaced. Permanently installed stone or brick barbecues with chimneys and spark arrestors are permitted only with prior CMA approval and must be located safely away from trees and shrubs.

**Slightly edited for space.**
**Full document online: CMA Basic Rules**

## Board Shorts

November 9 Board Meeting

- Approved minutes of May 18 Board Meeting
- Approved minutes of Aug 3 Board Meeting
- Site manager addressing "washboarding" on Salmon Lane
- Firewise has met volunteer hours requirement for annual renewal
- Repaired alarm system on Weinberger Reservoir
- Motion approved to install Aqua Mag System to treat water on North System
- Lagoon winterized and sewer line repaired
- Motion approved to replace South Well Signal Wire

December 14 Board Meeting

- Approved minutes of Nov 9 Board Meeting
- Water alarm modem replaced with 4G model
- Quarterly water testing was in compliance
- Motion approved to award snow plowing contract to Almost Heaven Property Mgmt, Steve Katz contract manager
- Motion approved to award financial review contract to David Decker, Dawne Holz contract manager
- Motion approved to award Directory printing contract to Allegra Print & Design
- Motion approved to assess $50 late fee on outstanding accounts after January 31, 2020
- Motion approved to continue site manager contract with Almost Heaven Property Mgmt on a month-to-month basis, Sharon Geno to review contract
- Joan Claybrook resigned, effective 12/31/19

January 4 Board Meeting

- Approved minutes of Dec 14 Board Meeting
- Elected Officers for 2020 (see box at right)
- Motion approved to award contract for Reserve Study to Reserve Advisors, Dawne Holz contract manager
- 2020 meeting calendar set, See page 2
- Board seat and Committee appointments postponed to March
- New home being built on lot H-5

## Assessments Paid?

Just a reminder that annual assessments were due by January 31. If you haven't already sent in payment please do so right away. A late fee and interest may be added to overdue accounts. Please note the new assessment amounts for 2020:

| | | |
|---|---|---|
| Assessment for Houses | | $1525 |
| Assessment for Lots | | $875 |
| Pool Fee, Rental Property | (Due in May) | $71 |

## Water Issues?

**Warm Springs Public Service District**

Weekdays, 9:00 am to 5:00 pm:
304-258-4118

All other times Morgan County non-emergency: 304-258-0305

Provide your name, address, lot number and the nature of the problem.

## Coolfont Mountainside Association

P.O. Box 418, Berkeley Springs, WV 25411

**Board of Directors**

Jason Géno, President
Steve Katz, Vice President
Tom Holz, Secretary
Dawne Holz, Treasurer
Sharon Géno, Director
Cindy Van Meter, Director
Vacant Position, See page 2

**Website**

www.coolfontmountainside.org
User ID: owner Password: coolfont

**Listserv Email**

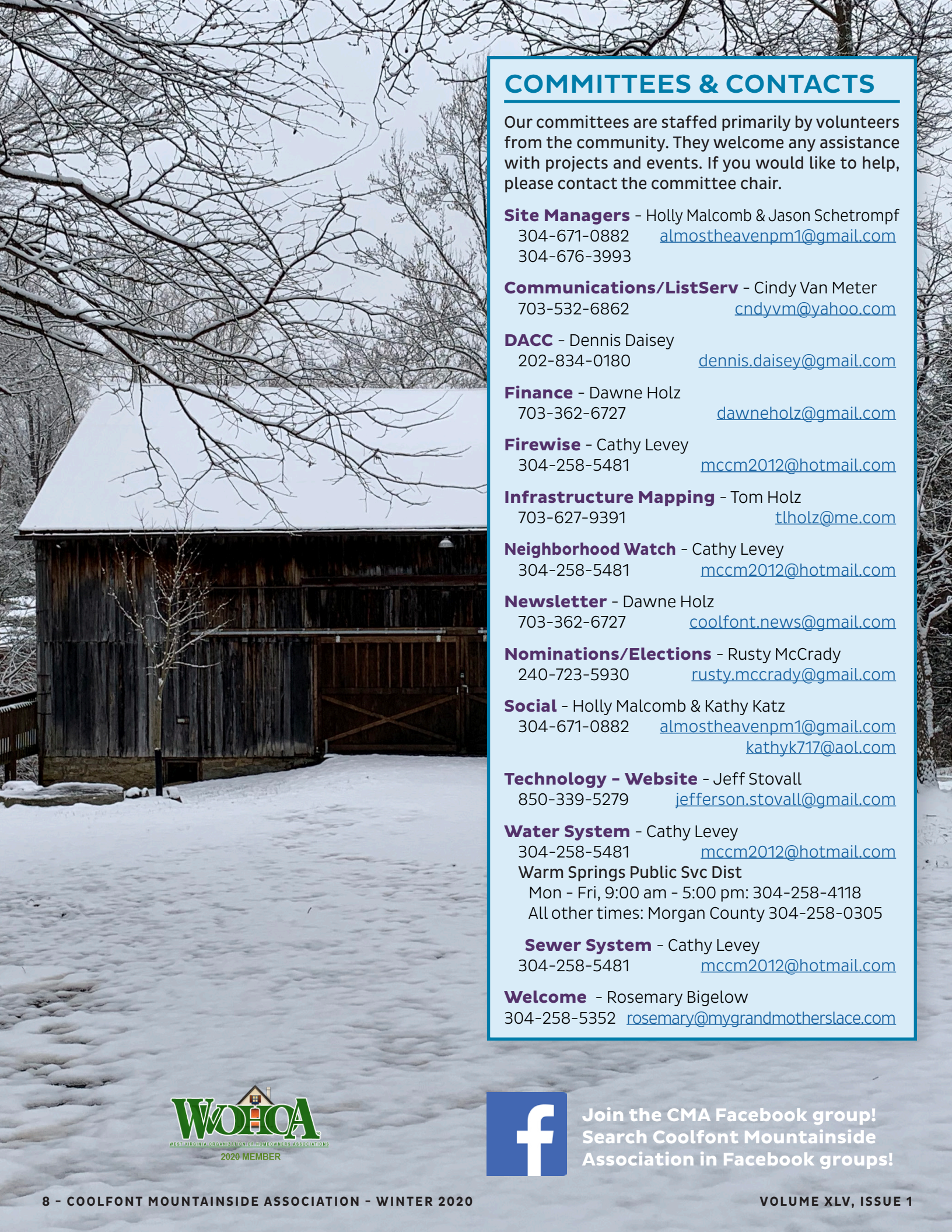
cma-members@googlegroups.com

**Listserv Signup/Web**

groups.google.com/forum/#!forum/cma-members

**Facebook**

www.facebook.com/groups/257606361406



## COMMITTEES & CONTACTS

Our committees are staffed primarily by volunteers from the community. They welcome any assistance with projects and events. If you would like to help, please contact the committee chair.

**Site Managers** - Holly Malcomb & Jason Schetrompf
304-671-0882 almostheavenpm1@gmail.com
304-676-3993

**Communications/ListServ** - Cindy Van Meter
703-532-6862 cndyvm@yahoo.com

**DACC** - Dennis Daisey
202-834-0180 dennis.daisey@gmail.com

**Finance** - Dawne Holz
703-362-6727 dawneholz@gmail.com

**Firewise** - Cathy Levey
304-258-5481 mccm2012@hotmail.com

**Infrastructure Mapping** - Tom Holz
703-627-9391 tlholz@me.com

**Neighborhood Watch** - Cathy Levey
304-258-5481 mccm2012@hotmail.com

**Newsletter** - Dawne Holz
703-362-6727 coolfont.news@gmail.com

**Nominations/Elections** - Rusty McCrady
240-723-5930 rusty.mccrady@gmail.com

**Social** - Holly Malcomb & Kathy Katz
304-671-0882 almostheavenpm1@gmail.com
kathyk717@aol.com

**Technology – Website** - Jeff Stovall
850-339-5279 jefferson.stovall@gmail.com

**Water System** - Cathy Levey
304-258-5481 mccm2012@hotmail.com
Warm Springs Public Svc Dist
Mon - Fri, 9:00 am - 5:00 pm: 304-258-4118
All other times: Morgan County 304-258-0305

**Sewer System** - Cathy Levey
304-258-5481 mccm2012@hotmail.com

**Welcome** - Rosemary Bigelow
304-258-5352 rosemary@mygrandmotherslace.com

WOHOA
WEST VIRGINIA ORGANIZATION OF HOMEOWNERS ASSOCIATIONS
2020 MEMBER

**Join the CMA Facebook group! Search Coolfont Mountainside Association in Facebook groups!**